

Class5: Data Viz with ggplot2

Rowen (PID: A18363990)

2026-04-14

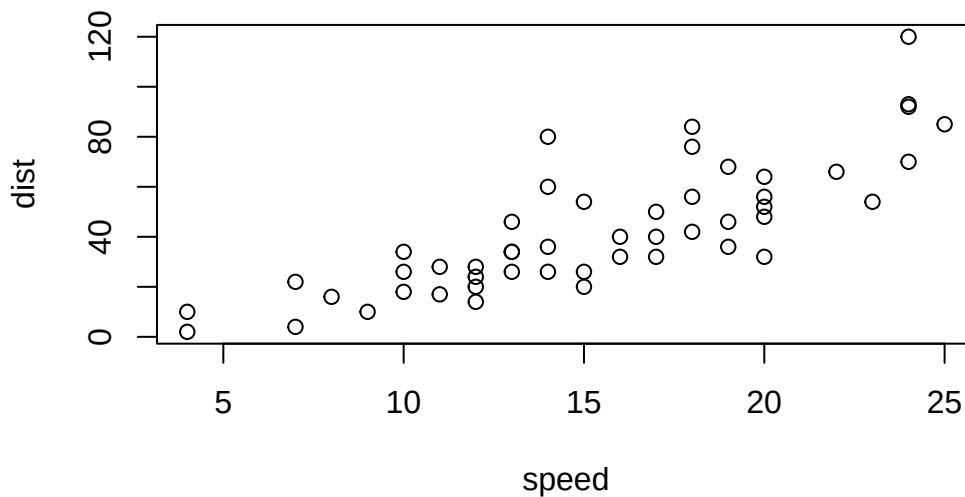
#Background

There are many graphics systems in R for making plots and figures. These include so-called “base R” *graphics* like the `plot()` function and add on packages like **ggplot2**.

Let’s compare how we make a simple figure with these two systems:

We can use the in-built ‘cars’ dataset:

```
plot(cars)
```



Before I can use ggplot 2 I need to install it on my computer.

To do this we can use the function `install.packages("ggplot2")`

>**N.B.** We never run `install.packages()` in our quarto doc (we run it once only in our R console) as it would re-install the package every time we render our report.

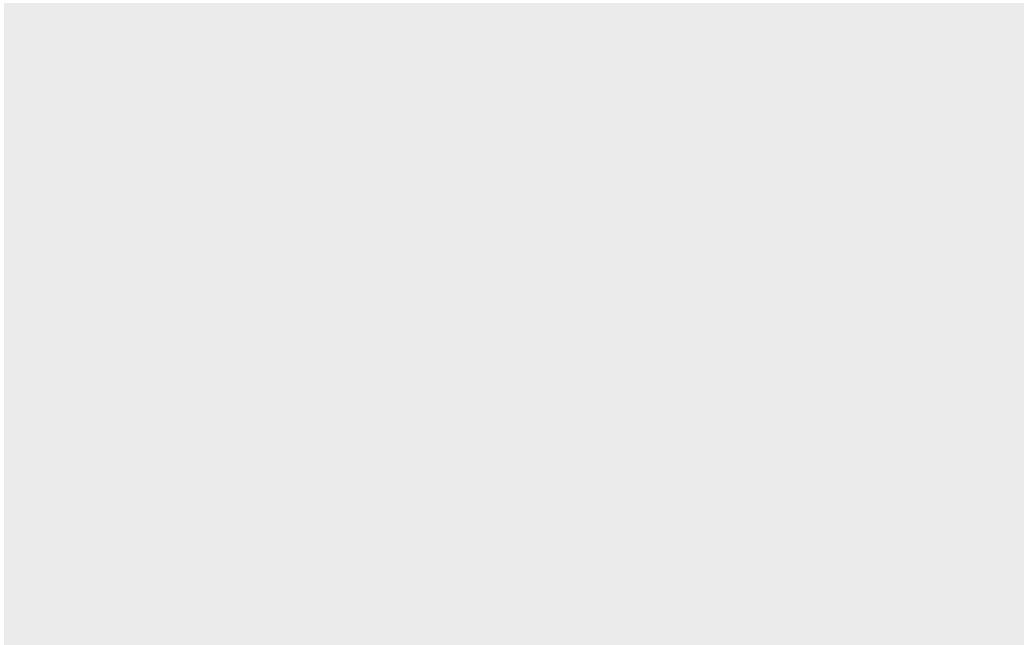
Once installed we need to load up the package into our R brain:

```
library(ggplot2)
```

Warning: package 'ggplot2' was built under R version 4.4.3

The main function in the ggplot2 package is called `ggplot()`

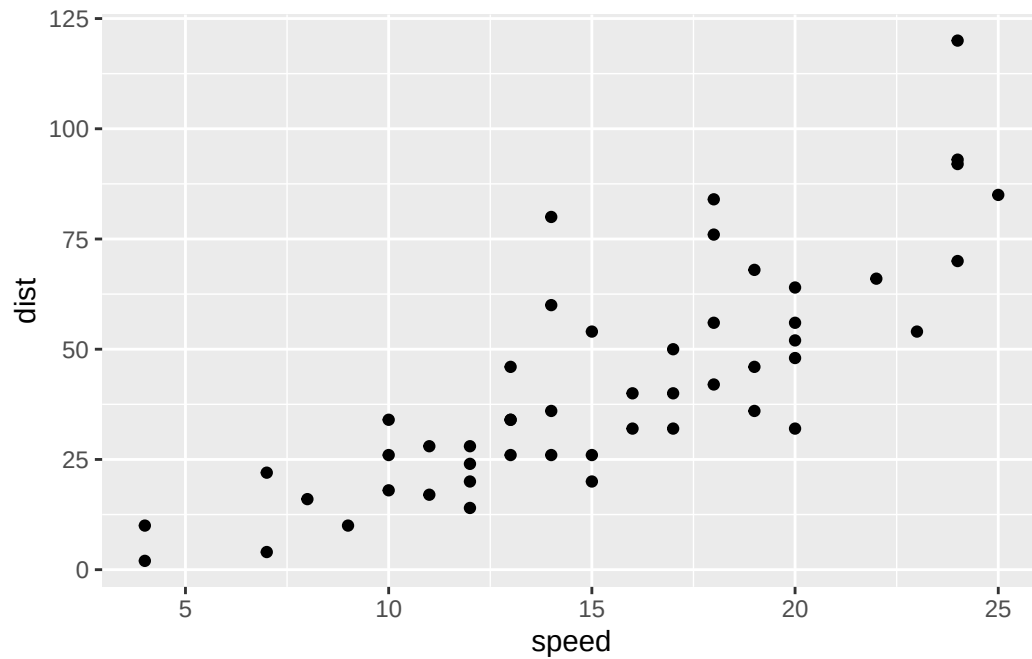
```
ggplot(cars)
```



Every ggplot has at least 3 layers:

- The **data** (a data.frame of the stuff we want to plot)
- The **aesthetics** (how the data maps to the plot)
- The **geom layer** (how you want the plot drawn, e.g. points, lines, etc.)

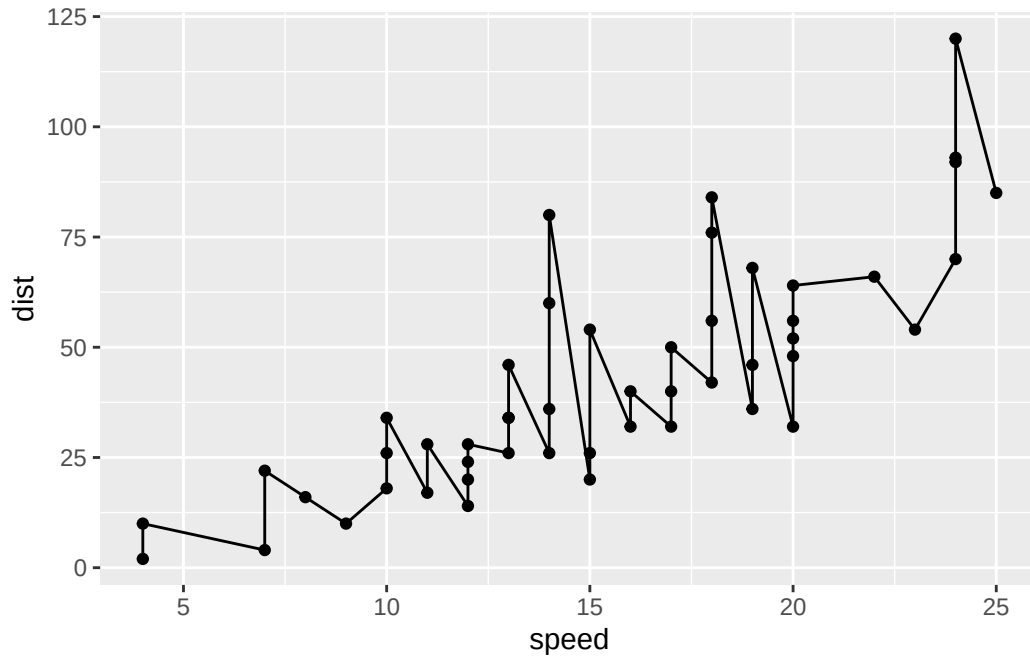
```
ggplot(cars) +  
  aes(x=speed, y=dist) +  
  geom_point()
```



Add some custom features

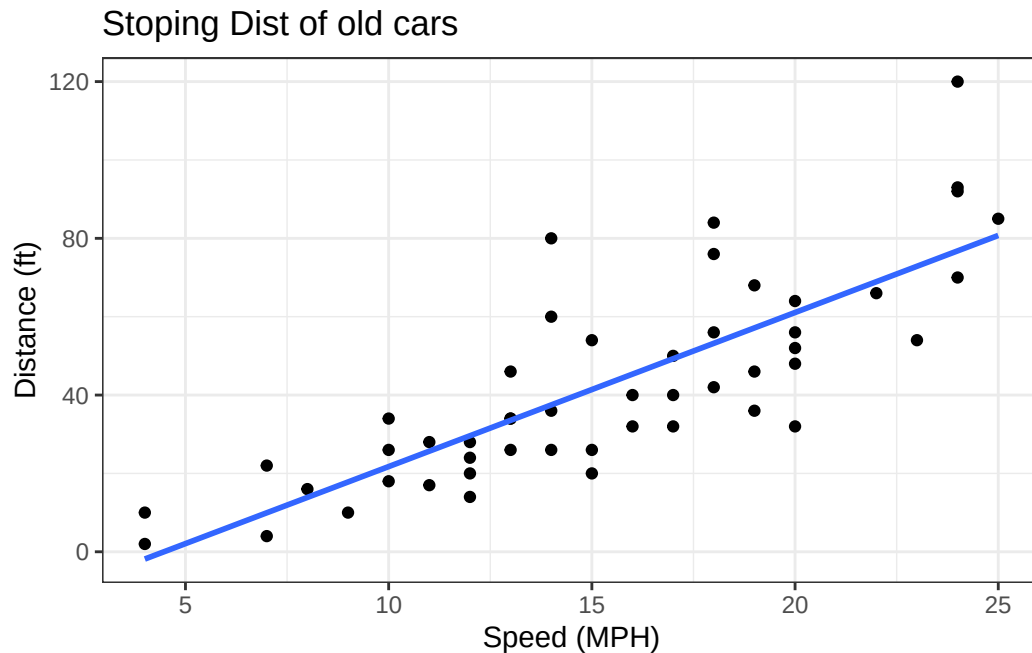
Let's add a trend line that shows the relationship between speed and distance.

```
ggplot(cars) +  
  aes(x=speed, y=dist) +  
  geom_point() +  
  geom_line()
```



```
ggplot(cars) +  
  aes(x=speed, y=dist) +  
  geom_point() +  
  geom_smooth(method = "lm", se = FALSE) +  
  theme_bw() +  
  labs(title="Stopping Dist of old cars",  
        x="Speed (MPH)",  
        y="Distance (ft)")
```

`geom\_smooth()` using formula = 'y ~ x'



Q. Can you make the `geom_smooth()` function produce a linear straight line fit to the data and turn off the “gray” error region.

Important data

```
url <- "https://bioboot.github.io/bimm143_S20/class-material/up_down_expression.txt"
genes <- read.delim(url)
head(genes)
```

	Gene	Condition1	Condition2	State
1	A4GNT	-3.6808610	-3.4401355	unchanging
2	AAAS	4.5479580	4.3864126	unchanging
3	AASDH	3.7190695	3.4787276	unchanging
4	AATF	5.0784720	5.0151916	unchanging
5	AATK	0.4711421	0.5598642	unchanging
6	AB015752.4	-3.6808610	-3.5921390	unchanging

```
sum(genes$State == "up")
```

```
[1] 127
```

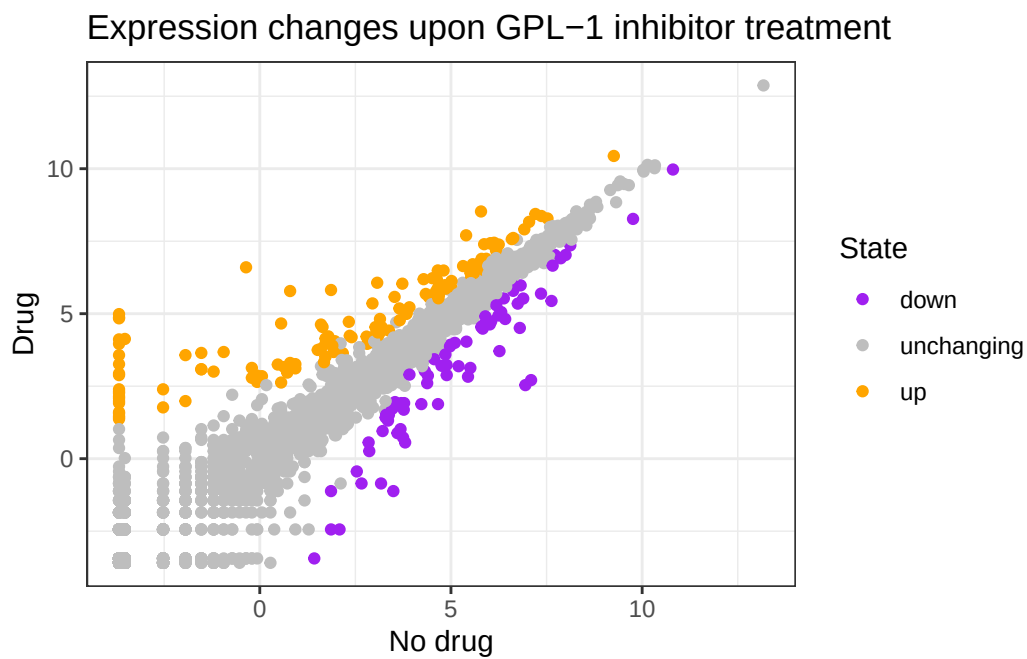
A useful new function in this context is the `table()` function:

```
table(genes$State)
```

down	unchanging	up
72	4997	127

My first plot attempt

```
ggplot(genes) +  
  aes(Condition1, Condition2, col=State) +  
  geom_point() +  
  scale_color_manual(values=c("purple", "gray", "orange")) +  
  theme_bw()+  
  labs(x="No drug", y="Drug",  
        title="Expression changes upon GPL-1 inhibitor treatment")
```



Going further

Here we read the famous gapminder data set:

```
# File location online
url <- "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/jennybc/gapminder/master/inst/extdata/gapminder.tsv"

gapminder <- read.delim(url)
head(gapminder)
```

	country	continent	year	lifeExp	pop	gdpPercap
1	Afghanistan	Asia	1952	28.801	8425333	779.4453
2	Afghanistan	Asia	1957	30.332	9240934	820.8530
3	Afghanistan	Asia	1962	31.997	10267083	853.1007
4	Afghanistan	Asia	1967	34.020	11537966	836.1971
5	Afghanistan	Asia	1972	36.088	13079460	739.9811
6	Afghanistan	Asia	1977	38.438	14880372	786.1134

Q. How many entries (i.e. rows) are in this data set?

```
nrow(gapminder)
```

```
[1] 1704
```

Q. How many different “country” entries are in this dataset?

```
length(unique(gapminder$country))
```

```
[1] 142
```

```
unique(gapminder$country)
```

[1] "Afghanistan"	"Albania"
[3] "Algeria"	"Angola"
[5] "Argentina"	"Australia"
[7] "Austria"	"Bahrain"
[9] "Bangladesh"	"Belgium"
[11] "Benin"	"Bolivia"
[13] "Bosnia and Herzegovina"	"Botswana"
[15] "Brazil"	"Bulgaria"
[17] "Burkina Faso"	"Burundi"
[19] "Cambodia"	"Cameroon"
[21] "Canada"	"Central African Republic"
[23] "Chad"	"Chile"

[25] "China"	"Colombia"
[27] "Comoros"	"Congo, Dem. Rep."
[29] "Congo, Rep."	"Costa Rica"
[31] "Cote d'Ivoire"	"Croatia"
[33] "Cuba"	"Czech Republic"
[35] "Denmark"	"Djibouti"
[37] "Dominican Republic"	"Ecuador"
[39] "Egypt"	"El Salvador"
[41] "Equatorial Guinea"	"Eritrea"
[43] "Ethiopia"	"Finland"
[45] "France"	"Gabon"
[47] "Gambia"	"Germany"
[49] "Ghana"	"Greece"
[51] "Guatemala"	"Guinea"
[53] "Guinea-Bissau"	"Haiti"
[55] "Honduras"	"Hong Kong, China"
[57] "Hungary"	"Iceland"
[59] "India"	"Indonesia"
[61] "Iran"	"Iraq"
[63] "Ireland"	"Israel"
[65] "Italy"	"Jamaica"
[67] "Japan"	"Jordan"
[69] "Kenya"	"Korea, Dem. Rep."
[71] "Korea, Rep."	"Kuwait"
[73] "Lebanon"	"Lesotho"
[75] "Liberia"	"Libya"
[77] "Madagascar"	"Malawi"
[79] "Malaysia"	"Mali"
[81] "Mauritania"	"Mauritius"
[83] "Mexico"	"Mongolia"
[85] "Montenegro"	"Morocco"
[87] "Mozambique"	"Myanmar"
[89] "Namibia"	"Nepal"
[91] "Netherlands"	"New Zealand"
[93] "Nicaragua"	"Niger"
[95] "Nigeria"	"Norway"
[97] "Oman"	"Pakistan"
[99] "Panama"	"Paraguay"
[101] "Peru"	"Philippines"
[103] "Poland"	"Portugal"
[105] "Puerto Rico"	"Reunion"
[107] "Romania"	"Rwanda"
[109] "Sao Tome and Principe"	"Saudi Arabia"

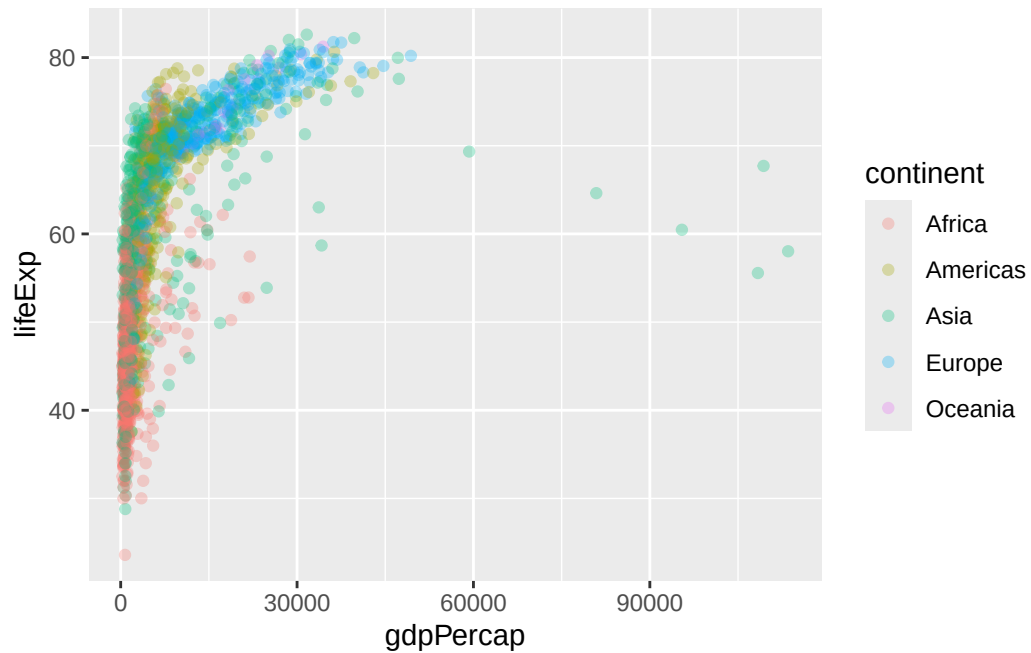
[111]	"Senegal"	"Serbia"
[113]	"Sierra Leone"	"Singapore"
[115]	"Slovak Republic"	"Slovenia"
[117]	"Somalia"	"South Africa"
[119]	"Spain"	"Sri Lanka"
[121]	"Sudan"	"Swaziland"
[123]	"Sweden"	"Switzerland"
[125]	"Syria"	"Taiwan"
[127]	"Tanzania"	"Thailand"
[129]	"Togo"	"Trinidad and Tobago"
[131]	"Tunisia"	"Turkey"
[133]	"Uganda"	"United Kingdom"
[135]	"United States"	"Uruguay"
[137]	"Venezuela"	"Vietnam"
[139]	"West Bank and Gaza"	"Yemen, Rep."
[141]	"Zambia"	"Zimbabwe"

Let's make our first plot of the entire dataset:

Plot of "gdpPercap" vs "lifeExp" colored by "continent"

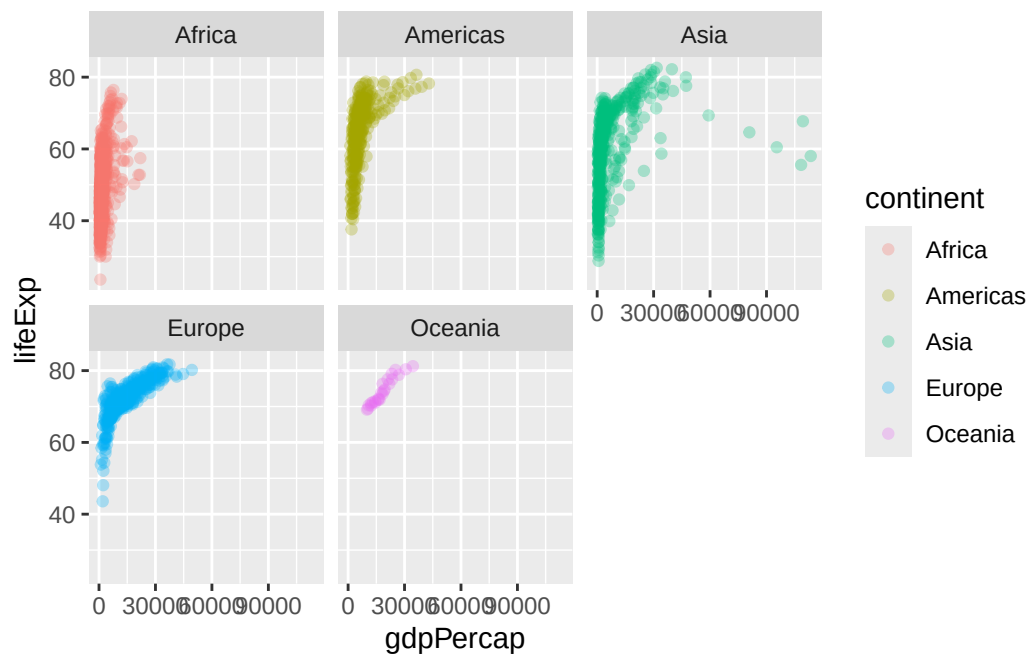
```
p <- ggplot(gapminder) +
  aes(gdpPercap, lifeExp, col=continent) +
  geom_point(alpha=0.3)
```

p



I can add more layers to 'p'

```
p +  
  facet_wrap(~continent)
```



Make a plot for 1977 and 2007 only (not all the years in the data set).

Q. First use the **dplyr** package and the `filter()` function from that package to extract the year 2007.

```
library (dplyr)
```

Attaching package: 'dplyr'

The following objects are masked from 'package:stats':

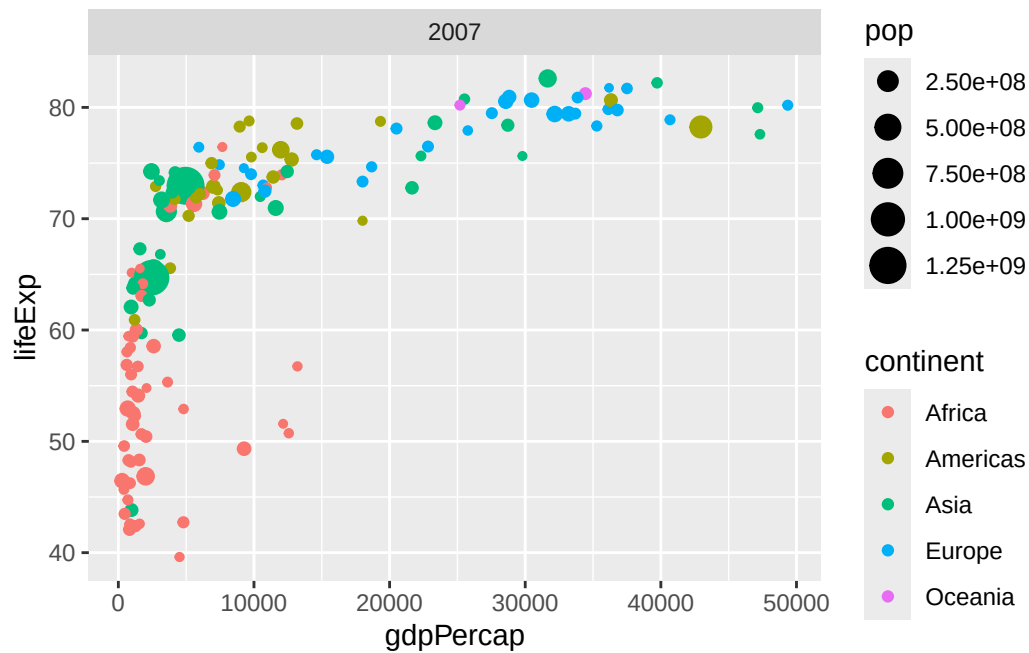
`filter`, `lag`

The following objects are masked from 'package:base':

`intersect`, `setdiff`, `setequal`, `union`

```
g07 <- filter(gapminder, year ==2007)
g77 <- filter(gapminder, year ==1977)
g <- filter(gapminder, year ==2007 | year ==1977)
```

```
ggplot(g07) +
  aes(gdpPercap, lifeExp, col=continent, size=pop) +
  geom_point() +
  facet_wrap(~year)
```



Q. Make a histogram of lifeExp colored by continent (try using `fill=continent` or `col=continent`)

Q. Make a histogram of lifeExp faceted by continent

```
ggplot(gapminder) +
  aes(x = lifeExp, col = continent) +
  geom_histogram()
```

``stat_bin()`` using ``bins = 30``. Pick better value ``binwidth``.

